AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN — REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Bastion

Hardening & Defensive Infrastructure Tools

68	222,692	72%	31
FREE TOOLS	COMMUNITY STARS	ON GITHUB ACTIVE	ACTIVE IN 2026

68 tools · Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — 1435 curated free tools across 14 realms · Data verified 2026-11-06 (re-verified monthly)

CURATOR'S NOTES

The mirror image of the Armory: what you install so you never get popped. Kernel-level audit, mandatory-access-control lineages (SELinux, OpenBSD PF), host hardening and firewall tooling — the unglamorous layer that stops real breaches.

MAINTENANCE SNAPSHOT (2026-11-06)

- **Active in the last 30 days:** 31 of 43 tracked GitHub repos (72%)
- **Quiet classics (no push in 12+ months, still listed):** OpenRASP
- **Earliest entries:** Fail2ban (2011), OpenVPN (2012), ClamAV (2012)

FLAGSHIP PICKS — THE HEAVYWEIGHTS

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	WHAT IT DOES
Fail2ban	18.9k	2011	2026-10-27 ✅	Daemon to ban hosts that cause multiple authentication errors
Lynis	16.6k	2013	2026-09-16	Lynis - Security auditing tool for Linux, macOS, and UNIX-based systems. Assists with compliance testing (HIPA…
CrowdSec	15.4k	2020	2026-10-30 ✅	Open-source IDS/IPS, WAF and bot detection for Linux, Windows, Docker and Kubernetes, with a crowdsourced bloc…
OpenVPN	14.8k	2012	2026-10-31 ✅	OpenVPN is an open source VPN daemon
OpenSnitch	14.2k	2017	2026-07-26	OpenSnitch is a GNU/Linux interactive application firewall inspired by Little Snitch.
OpenNHP	14k	2014	2026-10-30 ✅	Make your infrastructure invisible to attackers. OpenNHP implements the Network-infrastructure Hiding Protocol…

Full inventory — 68 curated tools · ranked by GitHub adoption · 2026-11-06 census · non-GitHub tools listed without stars

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
Fail2ban	18.9k	2011	2026-10-27 ✅	— the classic log-watching IPS that bans brute-forcing IPs; still the default answer on every Linux server. Used by sysadmins on millions of servers to stop brute force; the classic free guard no commercial tool needed to replace. (GPL-2.0)
DOMPurify	17.5k	2014	2026-11-01 ✅	— Fast, tolerant DOM-only sanitizer for HTML, MathML and SVG that prevents XSS. Used by web developers worldwide; the de facto browser sanitizer library. (Apache-2.0)
Lynis	16.6k	2013	2026-09-16	— agentless system auditing and hardening with CIS/PCI-DSS-aligned findings; runs anywhere in minutes. Used by system auditors running CIS-style hardening checks; the open-source alternative to commercial compliance scanners for Linux/Unix hosts. (GPL-3.0)
CrowdSec	15.4k	2020	2026-10-30 ✅	— collaborative behavior-detection engine with a global IP-reputation network; the modern Fail2ban, 60x faster and IPv6-ready. Used by server administrators and hosting providers; the open-source, crowdsourced alternative to commercial WAF and bot-management services.
OpenVPN	14.8k	2012	2026-10-31 ✅	— the industry-standard open-source VPN daemon for site-to-site and remote-access tunnels. Used by IT teams everywhere; the open-source alternative to commercial VPN gateways. (GPL-2.0 core, component exceptions)

OpenSnitch	14.2k	2017	2026-07-26	— interactive application firewall (Little Snitch for Linux): allow/deny every outbound connection per process. Used by Linux power users and admins wanting per-application firewall control; the open equivalent of Little Snitch on macOS. (GPL-3.0)
OpenNHP	14k	2014	2026-10-30 ✅	— go implementation of the Cloud Security Alliance's Network-infrastructure Hiding Protocol: conceals ports, IPs and domains behind a cryptographically signed knock gate — services stay invisible until the client proves trust. Used by zero-trust teams making infrastructure undiscoverable to mass and AI-driven scanning; the reference open implementation of CSA NHP. (Apache-2.0)
Vuls	12.3k	2016	2026-11-01 ✅	— agentless vulnerability scanner for servers and containers, with CVE reporting across Linux and FreeBSD fleets. Used by server admins for agentless vulnerability scanning; the open-source alternative to Nessus for host patch audits. (GPL-3.0)
BunkerWeb	11.2k	2019	2026-10-31 ✅	— next-gen open WAF built on nginx: HTTPS, bot mitigation and network protections on by default. Used by web admins wanting a next-gen open-source WAF in front of their sites; the self-hosted alternative to Cloudflare's managed WAF. (AGPL-3.0)
testssl.sh	9.3k	2014	2026-10-28 ✅	— command-line TLS/SSL configuration auditor: protocols, ciphers, chains, vulnerabilities, grading — no agent required. Used by TLS auditors and pentesters everywhere; the free command-line alternative to Qualys SSL Labs for server-side TLS grading. (GPL-2.0)
ClamAV	7.5k	2012	2026-10-22 ✅	— the open-source antivirus engine that powers mail gateways and file-screening pipelines everywhere. Used on countless mail gateways and Linux file screens; the AV engine many commercial mail filters embed. (GPL-2.0)
Fleet	7.1k	2020	2026-11-01 ✅	— osquery fleet management: device visibility and policy enforcement at scale, open core with a free tier. Used by IT and security teams managing osquery fleets at scale; the open-source alternative to commercial device management and EDR consoles. (MIT, open core)
dev-sec hardening collection	5.5k	2015	2026-10-22 ✅	— battle-tested Ansible roles for OS, SSH, nginx and MySQL baselines; hardening as code. Used by DevOps teams enforcing server baselines as code; the open-source alternative to commercial configuration-compliance agents.
js-xss	5.3k	2012	2026-10-24 ✅	— JavaScript library that sanitizes untrusted HTML against a whitelist to prevent XSS. Used by web developers; a widely adopted client-side sanitizer.
OSSEC	5.1k	2013	2026-10-31 ✅	— the original open-source HIDS: log analysis, file integrity and rootkit detection (Wazuh's ancestor). Used by SOC teams on a budget for host intrusion detection; the veteran open HIDS that predates commercial EDR. (GPL-2.0)
OPNsense	4.8k	2014	2026-10-31 ✅	— open-source firewall/router distro with IDS, VPN and reporting — a pfSense successor built on HardenedBSD. Used by network administrators as a full open-source firewall/router; the business-ready free alternative to commercial UTM appliances. (BSD-2)
CISO Assistant	4.6k	2023	2026-11-05 ✅	— Open-source GRC platform simplifying governance, risk, and compliance management while supporting over 70 frameworks worldwide. Used by security and compliance teams; a modern framework-agnostic GRC. (MIT)
ssh-audit	4.3k	2017	2026-10-17 ✅	— SSH server configuration auditor: algorithms, keys and best-practice flags in one run. Used by server hardening teams to audit SSH configurations and algorithms; the standard free SSH auditor. (GPL-3.0)
OpenSSH	4.1k	2014	2026-10-31 ✅	— the world's default secure remote-access suite: encrypted shells, tunnels and key management. Used on virtually every Linux server on earth; the open standard for secure remote access that commercial SSH servers complement, not replace. (BSD-style)
Coraza	4k	2020	2026-10-31 ✅	— ModSecurity-compatible WAF engine in Go; the actively developed successor for OWASP CRS deployments. Used by platform teams embedding a WAF engine inside Go services.
Fort Firewall	3.7k	2014	2026-11-05 ✅	— Windows-only open-source firewall built on the Windows Filtering Platform with app groups and wildcard path matching. Used by Windows users; a lightweight host firewall alternative. (GPL-3.0)
OWASP Core Rule Set	3.3k	2020	2026-11-01 ✅	— the world's most-deployed WAF ruleset; battle-tested protection for web servers, tuned for ModSecurity and Coraza. Used by WAF administrators on nginx, Apache and Coraza; the free ruleset protecting more sites than most commercial WAF feeds.

OpenRASP	3k	2017	2025-10-02 ⏳	— runtime application self-protection: instrument the app itself so attacks get blocked from the inside. Used by AppSec teams adding runtime self-protection to apps; the open-source alternative to commercial RASP vendors.
ComplianceAsCode content	2.8k	2014	2026-10-31 ✅	— the open SCAP/Baseline rule corpus for RHEL, Ubuntu and friends; the content that powers OpenSCAP-style audits. Used by compliance and platform teams applying SCAP hardening profiles; the open-source ruleset commercial compliance products build on.
checksec.sh	2.4k	2014	2026-10-28 ✅	— one-shot binary hardening audit: NX, canaries, PIE, RELRO and fortify flags in a single run. Used by exploit developers and binary auditors checking hardening mitigations; the standard free one-liner for this job. (BSD-3-Clause)
Neo23x0 auditd config	2k	2018	2026-05-04	— Florian Roth's hardened auditd rule set: the Linux logging baseline used across incident-response teams. Used by blue teams hardening Linux audit collection; the widely-forked open auditd baseline behind many SOC deployments. (Apache-2.0)
open-appsec	1.7k	2022	2026-09-06	— ML-driven prevention engine that stops OWASP Top 10 and zero-day web attacks without signatures. Used by security teams deploying machine-learning WAF protection; an open-source alternative to commercial ML-based WAF products.
SELinux	1.7k	2014	2026-10-30 ✅	— mandatory access control for Linux: policy-based confinement that survives a compromised application. Used by hardened enterprise Linux deployments; the mandatory access control standard in RHEL-family distributions. (GPL-2.0)
UUSEC WAF	1.7k	2022	2026-11-04 ✅	— Open-source web application firewall and API security gateway from UUCORP. Used by defenders and sysadmins; a free WAF option for protecting web services. (BSD-2-Clause)
shellfirm	951	2021	2026-10-29 ✅	— a pre-execution guard for your shell: challenges dangerous commands (rm -rf, kubectl delete) before they run. Used by engineers protecting themselves from dangerous commands; a lightweight open guardrail before your shell executes rm -rf. (Apache-2.0)
AIDE	759	2019	2026-10-22 ✅	— Advanced Intrusion Detection Environment: file-integrity monitoring that alerts the moment system files change. Used by hardening teams for file-integrity monitoring; the free open alternative to commercial FIM modules. (GPL-2.0)
Pompelmi	682	2025	2026-05-23 ⏳	— In-process file-upload security middleware for Node.js that scans untrusted uploads for malware, MIME spoofing and risks. Used by Node developers; a practical upload-hardening library. (ISC)
stunnel	398	2015	2026-09-17	— universal TLS wrapper that adds encryption to any TCP service in minutes. Used by admins adding TLS to legacy services; the free universal TLS wrapper. (GPL-2.0)
Artillery	338	2012	2020-09-30 ⏳	— Blue team tool designed to protect Linux and Windows systems through multiple defensive methods. Used by defenders and system administrators; a hardening and detection utility from TrustedSec.
FCaptcha	232	2025	2026-11-04 ✅	— Self-hosted CAPTCHA with behavioral analysis, vision-AI agent detection, headless-browser fingerprinting and proof-of-work. Used by web developers; a modern bot-defense component. (MIT)
GovReady-Q	223	2016	2024-12-10 ⏳	— Self-service open-source GRC tool automating security assessments and compliance documentation for frameworks like SOC 2 and ISO. Used by compliance teams; a documentation automation platform. (Apache-2.0)
SigFW	157	2017	2024-10-14 ⏳	— Open-source signaling firewall for SS7 and Diameter filtering with anti-spoofing and anti-sniffing capabilities. Used by telecom operators and security engineers; a defensive signaling filter. (AGPL-3.0)
Pavois	135	2026	2026-11-04 ✅	— Linux compliance and hardening tool over CINC/InSpec producing A-E grades with multi-standard mappings including CIS and ANSSI BP-028. Used by compliance engineers; a graded hardening assessor. (Apache-2.0)
unmask	6	2026	2026-10-31 ✅	— self-hosted privacy-first bot management gateway with verified-crawler bypass. Used by teams filtering bot traffic without third-party SaaS; the self-hosted bot-defense gateway. (Apache-2.0)
Sentinel Antivirus	6	2026	2026-09-19 ⏳	— Lightweight open-source antivirus engine for Windows with YARA scanning, PE machine-learning classification, and a kernel minifilter driver. Used by defenders and tinkerers; a compact free endpoint scanner. (MIT)

Owlyshield	4	2025	2025-12-01 ⏳	— Open-source EDR framework in Rust for Linux and Windows servers that analyzes process file behavior. Used by defenders and researchers; a lightweight open endpoint detection option. (EUPL-1.2)
WebDecoy	1	2026	2026-10-21 ✅	— Zero-configuration WordPress bot-detection plugin combining WebDriver detection, headless fingerprinting, behavioral analysis and CAPTCHA. Used by WordPress site owners; a simple bot-defense add-on. (GPL-2.0)
Hardenix	0	2026	2026-11-04 ✅	— OpenSCAP-powered Linux hardening CLI combining compliance scanning with Lynis second-opinion audits and OVAL-based CVE detection. Used by Linux admins; a practical hardening workflow. (GPL-3.0)
Netfilter/iptables	—	—	—	— the Linux kernel's native packet-filtering framework; the foundation every host firewall build starts from. Used by every Linux firewall admin; the kernel-level packet filter that commercial Linux firewalls wrap a UI around. (GPL-2.0)
OpenBSD PF	—	—	—	— the packet filter famous for correctness and readable rules; the syntax OpenBSD, pfSense and OPNsense share. Used by OpenBSD and firewall admins; the famously audited packet filter behind many security appliances. (ISC)
Qubes OS	—	—	—	— the security-by-compartmentalization desktop OS; " reasonably secure" by architecture, not by antivirus. Used by journalists, researchers and high-risk users; the compartmentalized security desktop with no commercial counterpart. (GPL-2.0)
SpamAssassin	—	—	—	— the veteran open-source spam filter; bayesian scoring and rule engine at the mail gateway. Used by mail administrators on countless gateways; the veteran open-source anti-spam engine many commercial filters license. (Apache-2.0)
Tor	—	—	—	— the anonymity network: routed egress through thousands of volunteer relays; the standard for privacy-preserving research access. Used by privacy-focused researchers, journalists and investigators; the free anonymity network with no commercial equivalent. (BSD-3-Clause)
Credential Guard	—	—	—	— Windows security feature isolating LSASS secrets via virtualization-based security, making credential extraction significantly harder. Used by Windows admins; a built-in hardening control. (free, proprietary)
LAPS (Local Administrator Passwo…	—	—	—	— Microsoft solution managing local administrator passwords on domain-joined computers, enforcing uniqueness and limiting lateral movement. Used by Windows admins; a built-in hardening tool. (free, proprietary)
Samhain	—	—	—	— Open-source multiplatform HIDS providing file integrity checking, log monitoring, rootkit detection, and port monitoring. Used by sysadmins; a long-standing host intrusion detection tool.
pfSense	—	—	—	— Widely deployed open-source FreeBSD-based firewall with the largest community and extensive third-party documentation. Used by network admins; a mature perimeter security platform. (Apache-2.0)
IPFire	—	—	—	— Hardened Linux firewall splitting networks into color-coded trust zones (LAN, DMZ, wireless, internet). Used by network admins; a security-first perimeter firewall. (GPL-2.0)
VyOS	—	—	—	— Open-source network operating system providing routing alongside firewall features with a Juniper-like CLI. Used by network engineers; a capable open routing and firewall platform. (GPL-2.0)
Portmaster	—	—	—	— PC-based firewall suite hooking into the network stack via WFP on Windows and nfqueue/eBPF on Linux. Used by privacy-conscious users; a granular per-app network firewall. (GPL-3.0)
Microsoft Defender for Endpoint	—	—	—	— Enterprise endpoint detection and response platform bundled with Microsoft 365 subscriptions. Used by enterprise security teams; a mature EDR option for Microsoft-centric organizations. (free tier)
GrapheneOS	—	—	—	— Privacy and security-hardened Android OS for Pixel devices with no Google services by default and a hardened memory allocator. Used by mobile security enthusiasts; a hardened mobile platform. (MIT)
OpenSCAP	—	—	—	— Reference implementation of the SCAP standard, NIST-certified and built into RHEL and derivatives. Used by compliance teams; the standard baseline for automated configuration scanning. (LGPL-2.1)
Wazuh SCA (Security Configuratio…	—	—	—	— Built-in compliance assessment module within the Wazuh SIEM performing policy monitoring and configuration checks against CIS Benchmarks. Used by SOC teams; free configuration assessment inside an open platform. (GPL-2.0)

Ubuntu Security Guide (USG)	—	—	—	— Canonical's built-in compliance tooling for Ubuntu providing CIS Benchmark profiles at Level 1 and Level 2 for workstations and servers. Used by Ubuntu admins; free automated hardening guidance. (free, proprietary)
SimpleRisk	—	—	—	— Lightweight open-source GRC platform focused on risk management for SMEs needing straightforward risk tracking. Used by small security teams; a simple governance and risk tool. (MPL-2.0)
Eramba	—	—	—	— Open-source GRC software providing governance, risk management, and compliance tools with a community-driven edition. Used by compliance teams; a broad GRC platform. (GPL-3.0)
OpenRMF	—	—	—	— Open-source Risk Management Framework tool focused on managing NIST RMF compliance and assessments with automated compliance checklists. Used by federal and enterprise assessors; a NIST-aligned GRC tool. (Apache-2.0)
MONARC	—	—	—	— Open-source risk analysis tool mapping assets, threats, and vulnerabilities for security assessments; used by risk managers and auditors. (GPL-3.0)
Subgraph OS	—	—	—	— Secure Linux distribution with a hardened kernel for privacy and resistance. Used by security-conscious users; a hardened desktop option.
sqlchop	—	—	—	— SQL injection detection engine offered as a web service by Chaitin. Used by defenders and developers; a hosted SQLi detection check. (free, proprietary)
xsschop	—	—	—	— XSS detection engine offered as a web service by Chaitin. Used by defenders and developers; a hosted cross-site scripting detection check. (free, proprietary)
Csper	—	—	—	— Set of tools for building, evaluating and monitoring Content-Security-Policy to prevent and detect cross-site scripting. Used by web security engineers; a practical CSP management suite. (free tier)